B1 Writing

Linking words: and, but, because, so

Join short sentences into clear, connected writing with the most useful linking words and the right punctuation.

Writing that is only short sentences sounds like a list. Linking words show how your ideas connect: adding, contrasting, giving a reason or a result. A few well-chosen linkers make a big difference in emails and exam answers.

Purpose	Linking words	Example
Adding	and, also, too, as well	*The hotel was clean. It was also very quiet.*
Contrast	but, although, however	*Although it rained, we enjoyed the trip.*
Reason	because, because of, as	*The flight was late because of the fog.*
Result	so, that's why	*I was tired, so I went to bed early.*
Order	first, then, after that, finally	*First we had lunch. Then we went to the museum.*

Punctuation. *However* starts a new sentence and takes a comma: *The food was good. However, it was expensive. Although* joins two parts of one sentence.

Common mistakes. *Because of* is followed by a noun, *because* by a clause: *because of the traffic* but *because the traffic was bad*. And don't use two linkers together: *Although it was cold, but we swam* is wrong; use only one.

Practice

1. Join with "so": It was late. We took a taxi.
2. Join with "although": The test was hard. I passed.
3. Correct the mistake: I stayed home because of I was ill.
4. Correct the mistake: Although the room was small, but it was comfortable.

5. Rewrite with "However": The phone is cheap. The battery is poor.

▼ **Show answers**

1. It was late, so we took a taxi.
2. Although the test was hard, I passed.
3. I stayed home because I was ill. (or: because of illness)
4. Although the room was small, it was comfortable.
5. The phone is cheap. However, the battery is poor.